Pioneering Quality and Affordable World-class Cardiac Care

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India has become a diabetes capital of India. With evolving lifestyle and risk factors, cardiac diseases are in the rise in our country. Similarly the cardiac facility and basic treatment has reached to grass root level offering treatment at right time. However, still much more needs to be done.

In India there is a gap between quality care and affordable care. Dr Rao is US trained interventional structural cardiologist who is a pioneer of Transcatheter cardiac treatment.

One such treatment is Transcatheter aortic valve replacement for patients suffering from severe aortic stenosis. Aortic stenosis refers to narrowing of aortic valve. Aortic valve controls the flow of blood from the heart to the body. As the office through which blood has to flow narrows, heart has to tomoimp with greater force. As a result patients would get breathless and develop chest pain or syncope. Once the patient develops symptoms, medcines don't work. Five year survival on medcines is less than 5 percent.

The only treatment is aortic valve replacement. Dr Rao is a pioneer of TAVR therapy in India. TAVR stands for Transcatheter aortic valve replacement, wherein the valve is replaced via a tube inserted in the groin vessel. There is no surgery involved. Patients have a shorter hospitla stay, less complications, faster recovery and better quality of life. Dr Rao published his outcomes in Indian heart journal which were at par with outcomes of published international trials. Patients would travel all parts of country and south-east Asia for treatment. His another focus has been on deliver complex and advanced cardiac treatment in the safest manner. Dr Rao has been invited to more than 50 hospitals in the country to proctor , train and perform TAVI procedure in a Minimalistic and safe manner. He has proctored TAVI at premier medical institutes of country like AIIMS, New Delhi, PGI Chandigarh, Sri Chitra Institute , Thiruvananthapuram. Outside India, he has been invited to more than 20 countries for TAVI.

He has pioneer in making successful the make in India , TAVI valve technology. Dr Rao performed the first in the world TAVR procedure with Indian TAVI valve successfully and the patient still continues to do well. He was the CO- PI(Prinipal Investigator) for the study and presented the data of the first in human trial at EURO PCR and London Valves 2019. At present, the Indian valve is approved in India and is used many European counties.

Dr Rao says, "TAVI/TAVR has become a stablished therapy for patients suffering from aortic stenosis. It has come a long way establishing its safety and durability. However, now we have to focus on safe outcomes as we move to low risk patients and younger population. The outcomes depend on the operator experience. At present having accumulated experience of more than 1000 TAVI procedures, we are able to provide safe outcomes during TAVI procedure. This helps patients to make a Conscious decision when it comes to safe cardiac treatment."

Dr Rao is also a pioneer in repairing leaky heart valves. Mitral regurgitation refers to leakage in the mitral valve. As a result the fluid accumulates in the lungs and these patients suffer from heart failure. MITRACLIP is a Catheter based mitral valve repair procedure. Dr Rao performed the first case in the country post approval of the device by DGCI. A catheter is inserted from the femoral valve and is advanced into the heart. The leakage spot is indentured and it's clipped, eliminating the leakage. This therapy has been a boon for patients suffering from heart failure. Many patients who were waiting for heart transplant did not require one after successful MitraClip.

He is an avid researcher and a compassionate doctor. His work on ROTABLATION for calcified blockages in Indian patients was accepted at EURO PCR 2023, which is one of the largest interventional cardiology conference. Three hundred plus Indian patients with calcified coronary blockages underwent successful rotablation with zero procedural deaths. As the Indian populations ages, complex coronary blockages appear. Not everyone can undergo CABG. Rotablation is established therapy for calcified blockages. The calcium is ablated and a stent is placed.

To bridge the gap between affordable and quality care , Dr Rao works as Vice Chairman of MJ RHL-Rajasthan Hospital, Jaipur. The hospital a multipseciatlty hospital with hand picked highly qualified, skilled and compassionate doctors. The aim of the organisation is quality care and affordable care. Dr Rao say, "RHL we focus on quality,safe and affordable care. Our clinicians provide patient centric care. Patient and their relatives are considered to be part of our clinician team with one and only motto- patient betterment and saving lives. Our departments would work in an integrated manner. With latest technology in CT scan, MRI, oncology, robotic angioplasty our clinicans are better equipped for patient care. The paramedical and nursing staff have a regular education program for upgradation and maintenance of quality care".